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STATE OF OKLAHOMA

2nd Session of the 60th Legislature (2026)

HOUSE BILL 3177 By: Archer of the House

By: Archer of the House

and

Howard of the Senate

AS INTRODUCED

An Act relating to court reporters; amending 20 O.S. 2021, Section 106.9, as last amended by Section 1, Chapter 263, O.S.L. 2023 (20 O.S. Supp. 2025, Section 106.9), which relates to court reporter salaries; authorizing the Director of Administration of the Corporation Commission to determine salaries for court reporters engaged by the Corporation Commission; and updating references.

BE IT ENACTED BY THE PEOPLE OF THE STATE OF OKLAHOMA:

SECTION 1. AMENDATORY 20 O.S. 2021, Section 106.9,
last amended by Section 1, Chapter 263, O.S.L. 2023 (20 O.S. §
106.9), is amended to read as follows:

Section 106.9. A. 1. Each court reporter regularly engaged by the district court, or the Workers' Compensation Court of Existing Claims, ~~or the Corporation Commission~~ shall be paid a salary pursuant to the salary schedule established by the annual appropriation for the district courts ~~and Corporation Commission~~.

1 in accordance with the job description for the position to which
2 appointed. For fiscal year 2023 and each fiscal year thereafter,
3 each court reporter shall receive an annual salary of Fifty-three
4 Thousand Dollars (\$53,000.00).

5 2. Each court reporter regularly engaged by the Corporation
6 Commission shall be paid a salary determined by the Director of
7 Administration of the Corporation Commission that is commensurate
8 with the court reporter's qualifications, experience, and additional
9 duties.

10 B. In addition to their base salaries, official court reporters
11 who are certified or licensed shorthand reporters and those acting
12 shorthand reporters pursuant to paragraph 3 of Section 106.3B of
13 this title shall be paid annually the sum of Four Hundred Dollars
14 (\$400.00) for each year of service to the district court, the
15 Workers' Compensation Court, and the Workers' Compensation Court of
16 Existing Claims ~~and the Corporation Commission~~, with a maximum of
17 twenty (20) years of service only to be used for the purpose of
18 longevity, not to exceed Eight Thousand Dollars (\$8,000.00) per
19 year, payable monthly. For the purpose of payment for longevity,
20 "years of service" is defined as all years served as a certified or
21 licensed court reporter in the district court, the Workers'
22 Compensation Court, and the Workers' Compensation Court of Existing
23 Claims ~~and the Corporation Commission~~ after June 30, 1978.

1 Longevity payments shall be made on July 1 of each year following
2 completion of the first year of service as defined herein.

3 C. In addition to their base salaries, official court reporters
4 eligible for longevity payments pursuant to subsection B of this
5 section shall be paid an annual equipment allowance of Three
6 Thousand Dollars (\$3,000.00). Payments for such allowance shall be
7 made on July 1 of each year following completion of the first year
8 of service as defined in subsection B of this section.

9 D. In addition to their base salaries, official court reporters
10 who are certified shorthand reporters shall be paid the following:

11 1. The sum of Two Thousand Dollars (\$2,000.00) per year,
12 payable monthly, to any official court reporter who is a Registered
13 Professional Reporter (RPR), as recognized by the State Board of
14 Examiners of Certified Shorthand Reporters. To qualify as a RPR, an
15 official court reporter shall have a proficiency level in reporting
16 testimony and proceedings of a speed of not less than two hundred
17 twenty-five (225) words per minute in taking a question-and-answer-
18 type dictation, two hundred (200) words per minute in taking a jury
19 charge and one hundred eighty (180) words per minute in taking
20 literary material, shall pass a Written Knowledge Test with a score
21 of at least seventy percent (70%), all as determined by an
22 examination recognized by the Board, and shall complete thirty (30)
23 hours of continuing education per three-year cycle commencing at the
24 date of recognition;

1 2. The sum of Two Thousand Dollars (\$2,000.00) per year,
2 payable monthly, to any official court reporter who is a Registered
3 Merit Reporter (RMR), as recognized by the State Board of Examiners
4 of Certified Shorthand Reporters. To qualify as a RMR, an official
5 court reporter shall have a proficiency level in reporting testimony
6 and proceedings of a speed of not less than two hundred sixty (260)
7 words per minute in taking a question-and-answer-type dictation, two
8 hundred forty (240) words per minute in taking a jury charge and two
9 hundred (200) words per minute in taking literary material, shall
10 pass a Written Knowledge Test with a score of at least seventy
11 percent (70%), all as determined by an examination recognized by the
12 Board, and shall complete thirty (30) hours of continuing education
13 per three-year cycle commencing at the date of recognition;

14 3. The sum of Two Thousand Dollars (\$2,000.00) per year,
15 payable monthly, to any official court reporter who is a Registered
16 Diplomat Reporter (RDR), as recognized by the State Board of
17 Examiners of Certified Shorthand Reporters, and who completes thirty
18 (30) hours of continuing education per three-year cycle commencing
19 at the date of recognition;

20 4. The sum of Two Thousand Dollars (\$2,000.00) per year,
21 payable monthly, to any official court reporter who is a Certified
22 Realtime Reporter (CRR), as recognized by the State Board of
23 Examiners of Certified Shorthand Reporters, and who completes thirty
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1 (30) hours of continuing education per three-year cycle commencing
2 at the date of recognition; or

3 5. Any official court reporter who is the holder of more than
4 one certification shall be compensated in the additional amounts
5 specified in paragraphs 1 through 4 of this subsection for each
6 certification up to a maximum of Eight Thousand Dollars (\$8,000.00)
7 per year over and above the reporter's base salary, payable monthly.

8 E. Court reporters temporarily employed by the district court,
9 Workers' Compensation Court of Existing Claims, or Corporation
10 Commission shall be compensated by the court fund of the court which
11 they serve at a rate to be set by such court. In addition, court
12 reporters temporarily employed pursuant to this subsection who are
13 required by the terms of their employment to travel outside their
14 county of residence shall receive reimbursement for mileage actually
15 and necessarily traveled to and from the place of attendance at a
16 rate not to exceed the rate of reimbursement specified in the State
17 Travel Reimbursement Act for state employees. Any travel
18 reimbursement shall be paid from the court fund of the court where
19 the service of the temporarily employed court reporter is provided.

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21 COMMITTEE REPORT BY: COMMITTEE ON APPROPRIATIONS AND BUDGET, dated
22 03/04/2026 - DO PASS, As Amended and Coauthored.
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